

2.Setting Up a Zoho Creator Account and Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

Aim:

To create a Zoho Creator account, develop a sample application, create forms, reports, and dashboards, and study the Zoho Creator platform architecture and interface.

Setting up Zoho Creator:

Step 1: Create a Zoho Creator Account

1. Open the Zoho Creator website.
2. Click **Sign Up**.
3. Enter your email address and create a password (or sign in using Google/Microsoft).
4. Verify your email if required.
5. Log in to the Zoho Creator dashboard.

Step 2: Create a Sample Application

1. Click **Create New Application**.
2. Select **Start from Scratch**.
3. Enter the application name (Example: **My First Creator App**).
4. Click **Create**.
5. The application is created successfully.

Step 3: Create a Form

1. Inside the application, click **Create → Form**.
2. Enter the form name
3. Add the following fields:
 - Customer Name

- Product Ordered
- Quantity
- Order date
- status

4. Click **Save**.

The screenshot shows the 'Add Order' form in the 'My first Creator app'. The form is titled 'Add New' and contains the following fields:

- Customer Name:** Two input fields for 'First Name' and 'Last Name'.
- Product Ordered:** A single-line text input field.
- Quantity:** A text input field containing '#####'.
- Order Date:** A date input field with the placeholder 'dd-MM-yyyy'.
- Est. Delivery Date:** A date input field with the placeholder 'dd-MM-yyyy'.
- Status:** A dropdown menu with '-Select-' as the selected option.
- Next Action:** A dropdown menu with '-Select-' as the selected option.
- Notes:** A multi-line text input field.

The left sidebar shows the app's navigation menu with options: Home, All Orders, and Add Order (highlighted). The top bar indicates the trial expires in 4 days and provides links for Upgrade, Edit this application, and Help.

Step 4: Create a Report

1. Click **Create** → **Report**.
2. Select **List Report**.
3. Click **Create**.

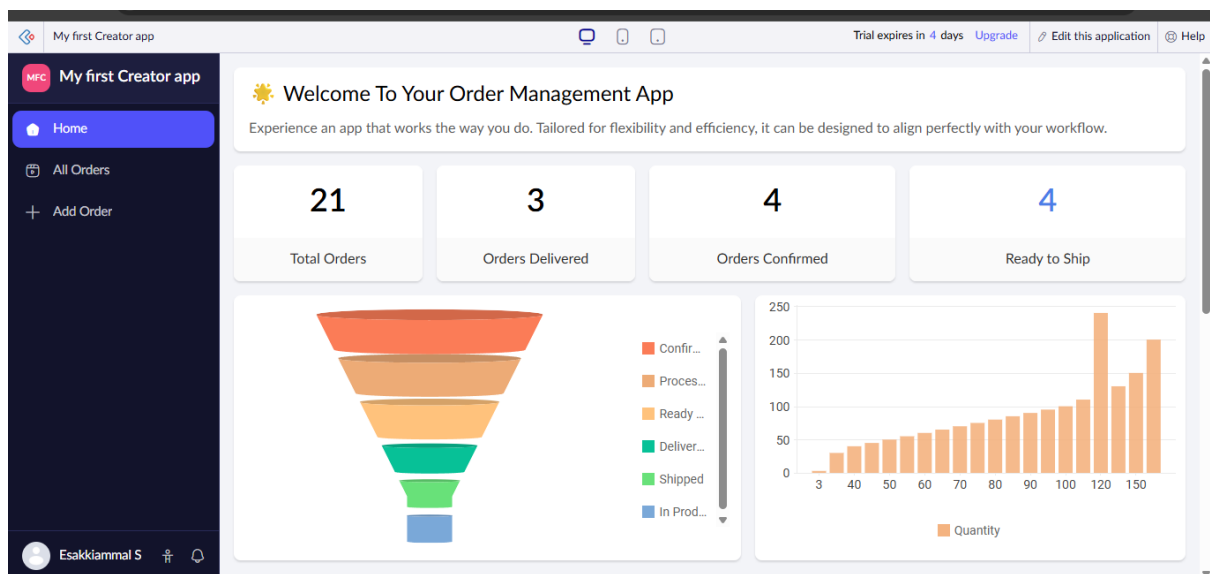
The screenshot shows the 'All Order Report' table in the 'My first Creator app'. The table has the following columns: Status, Customer Name, Product Ordered, Quantity, Order Date, and Est. Delivery Date. The data is as follows:

Status	Customer Name	Product Ordered	Quantity	Order Date	Est. Delivery Date
Ready to Ship	Indhu S	Dress	3	17-Jul-2026	23-Jul-2026
Processing	Jane Doe	Eco-Friendly Charger	100	01-Jun-2023	10-Jun-2023
Confirmed	John Smith	Solar Backpack	50	02-Jun-2023	12-Jun-2023
In Production	Alice Johnson	Smart Thermostat	75	03-Jun-2023	15-Jun-2023
Ready to Ship	Bob Brown	Wireless Earbuds	200	04-Jun-2023	18-Jun-2023
Shipped	Carol White	Fitness Tracker	150	05-Jun-2023	20-Jun-2023
Delivered	David Green	LED Desk Lamp	80	06-Jun-2023	22-Jun-2023
Processing	Ethan Foster	Portable Charger	60	07-Jun-2023	24-Jun-2023
Confirmed	Fiona Graham	Wireless Mouse	40	08-Jun-2023	25-Jun-2023
In Production	Gary Hughes	Bluetooth Keyboard	120	09-Jun-2023	28-Jun-2023
Ready to Ship	Hannah Irvine	Smartwatch	90	10-Jun-2023	30-Jun-2023

The left sidebar shows the app's navigation menu with options: Home, All Orders (highlighted), and Add Order. The top bar indicates the trial expires in 4 days and provides links for Upgrade, Edit this application, and Help. The bottom of the table shows 'Showing 21 of 21'.

Step 5: Create a Dashboard

1. Click **Create** → **Dashboard**.
2. Add components such as:
 - Student Report
 - Charts
 - KPI Widgets
3. Save the dashboard.



Exploring the Platform Architecture and Interface

Zoho Creator has three main components:

1. Develop Layer

The Develop layer is where applications are created and customized.

Components:

- Forms – Collect data from users.
- Reports – Display and analyze stored data.
- Pages – Create custom user interfaces.
- Workflows – Automate business processes.
- Deluge Scripting – Add custom logic and automation.
- Widgets – Embed external applications or custom components.

Purpose:

- Design applications
- Build forms and reports
- Automate tasks
- Customize business logic

2. Deploy Layer

The Deploy layer makes the application available to users.

Components:

- User Sharing
- Role-Based Access Control
- Mobile Application Support
- Web Application Publishing
- APIs and Integrations

Purpose:

- Publish applications
- Share with users
- Secure access
- Integrate with other applications
- Run on web and mobile devices

3. Manage Layer

The Manage layer is responsible for administration and maintenance.

Components:

- User Management
- Security Settings

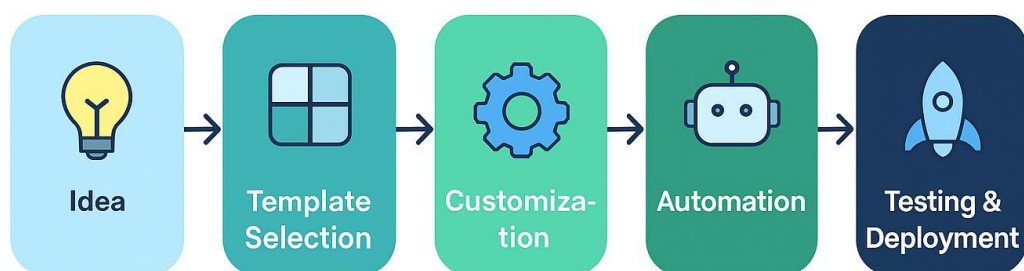
- Backup & Restore
- Audit Logs
- Performance Monitoring
- Version Control
- Application Settings

Purpose:

- Maintain applications
- Monitor performance
- Manage users
- Protect data
- Update and improve applications

Zoho Creator Architecture:

Zoho Creator 6.0 App Development



Zoho Creator Interface

The Zoho Creator interface contains the following main components:

1. Dashboard

Displays all applications created by the user.

Provides quick access to recent projects.

2. Application Builder

Used to create and manage applications.

Includes drag-and-drop tools for designing forms and pages.

3. Forms

Used to collect and store user information.

Supports text fields, date pickers, lookup fields, images, and file uploads.

4. Reports

Display stored records in table, list, calendar, or Kanban views.

Allow filtering, sorting, and searching of data.

5. Pages

Used to build custom dashboards with charts, widgets, and reports.

6. Workflows

Automate business processes using rules, notifications, approvals, and Deluge scripts.

7. Settings

Manage users, permissions, integrations, themes, and application deployment.